

Weeds and wildflowers

Wildflowers are pretty, but some spread so rapidly they can be troublesome to farmers.



Ragwort is immensely poisonous to horses, ponies, donkeys, and cattle.



Thistle fruits have parachutes. The seeds may be carried far and wide.



Daisies hug the ground and do well in short grass – such as on a lawn.



Cowslip is found in clearings and at the edge of woodland as well as in meadows.



Musk mallow produces pretty flowers from June to September.



Lady's bedstraw produces tiny, star-shaped flowers.



Field scabious can produce some 2,000 seeds per plant.



Clover is useful to farmers as it helps fertilize the soil. It is part of the pea family.



Dandelion heads are full of tiny petals, each of which turns into a seed.



Wood cranesbill is a woodland flower, but grows in hay meadows.



Buttercup flowers produce 30 seeds, so a large plant may have 22,000 seeds.

Life in a meadow

In summer, a healthy grass meadow is like a jungle in miniature. It is packed with different plants and animals.



Hidden away

A meadow may be inhabited by moles – almost blind creatures that remain below the ground.



European mole

Under the surface

Moles are capable miners, tunnelling long passages through the soil and producing tell-tale mounds of earth.

Campion flower

Watch out!

Crab spiders are powerful enough to catch bees and butterflies. They hide among the flowers, pouncing when prey comes close.

Crab spider

Hands on

Make yourself a miniature meadow inside a jar. Sprinkle a few seeds onto damp soil. Put the jar on a windowsill, keep it watered, and watch as the seeds grow.